

Clinical: Jyothi Yarraji clocked her fastest time of the season — 12.96 — to clinch a second consecutive Asian gold. **Below:** Avinash Sable won gold in 3000m steeplechase, even though he fell short of World qualification standard of 8:15.00.

eager for more.

Although Parul had already qualified for the World Championships at the Doha Diamond League last month, her new time ranks her seventh fastest in the world this season.

Jyothi Yarraji shrugged off a lengthy rain delay to win a second consecutive Asian gold in the women's 100m hurdles with her fastest time (12.96) of the season. Given the conditions — and the fact that her preparation was hampered by a hamstring strain a few weeks earlier — Jyothi's coaches believe she isn't far off the World Championships standard of 12.73.

Distance runner Avinash Sable also fell short of the World qualification standard of 8:15.00 in the men's 3000m steeplechase, but the time he managed (8:20.92) — as he cruised towards the finish line, even slowing down to acknowledge the applause on the final straight — suggests there's more to come.

For Sable, it seemed the title of Asian champion mattered more than the time.

Gold medals were also won by the Indian teams in the women's 4x400m relay and the 4x400m mixed relay — despite both falling short of national records.

Gulveer Singh, who completed a golden double in the 5000m and 10,000m, also fell short of his national records in both events, but made his priorities clear. "Timings are important, but it's more important to win the gold medal," says Gulveer.

Sachin might feel the same. While pleased to have come so close to Arshad in his international debut, he is already thinking about building on the performance.

"This was my first competition. I'll get better next time," he said.

